

Image: Knowing Who You Are & Whose You Are

Genesis 1:26-27



What Does "Image" Actually Mean?

The Hebrew Word: *Tselem*

In the ancient world, kings erected statues — *tselem* — in conquered territory. The statue declared: "The king's authority is here."

❗ God did not place a statue in the earth.
He placed you.

You are God's *tselem* — His representative, carrying His authority, displaying His presence wherever you go.

You Are an Ambassador

Chosen & Sent

Ambassadors don't appoint themselves. They are selected, trained, and deployed.

Speaks for Another

Their words carry the authority of the one who sent them not their own.

Your Assignment

"We are therefore Christ's ambassadors, as though God were making his appeal through us."
— 2 Cor. 5:20

Your identity is not self-generated. It is assigned. Your worth is not something you build , it is something you carry.

The Problem with the Mirror

The Real Battle

Most people live as **image-seekers**, not image-bearers. They manufacture an identity instead of walking in the one God already gave them.



Borrowed images crack under pressure. They do not hold.

"Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be **transformed** by the renewing of your mind."

— Romans 12:2

Metamorphoo — total transformation, from the inside out.

Three Things the **Image of God** Means for You



You Have Inherent Value

"Crowned them with glory and honor." — Psalm 8:5



You Are Built for Relationship

"Two are better than one." — Ecc. 4:9



You Are Called to Reflect, Not Replace

"Apart from me you can do nothing." — John 15:5

The Covered Mirror

When sin entered in Genesis 3, it did not **erase** the image of God in you. But it **covered** it.

 "All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." — Romans 3:23

Sin dims the reflection. But **Jesus came to remove the cloth.**

"We all, with unveiled faces, are being transformed into his image with ever-increasing glory."
— 2 Corinthians 3:18

When you give your life to Christ, you don't become someone unrecognizable. You become **more fully what you were always designed to be.**

Living as an Image-Bearer



Start with Identity, Not Activity

Before the phone. Before the schedule. Speak the truth: *"I am made in the image of God."*



Use the Image for Others

The image was never meant to be admired privately. Let it function publicly, at work, home, and community.



Filter What Defines You

Your past does not write your present. **"I have called you by name; you are mine."** — Isaiah 43:1



Return to the Creator When It Feels Dim

Go back to the Word — not your feelings. **"Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever."** — Heb. 13:8

You Are Not an Accident.

You are the **deliberate work** of a God who looked at everything He had made and then said:

"Now let us make someone who looks like Us."
That someone is you.

Walk in it.